



Shell Structure Of Nucleus

② SHELL STRUCTURE OF NUCLEI. MAGIC NUMBERS:
Central potential & Spin orbit Coupling.

Liquid drop model successfully explain the mass of nucleus, binding energy, fission etc but there are other properties which can not be explained by liquid drop model.

In order to explain few properties of Nucleus for which we have to imagine that there exist shells in the nucleus where proton and neutron can be accommodated similar to the electron shells outside nucleus. When a shell is completed by electron the last electron possesses maximum binding energy (ionization energy).



(b). The elements having proton number equal to the magic number have greater number of stable isotopes than the neighbouring atom.
e.g: For tin ($Z=50$) the stable isotopes are 10, while for Cadmium ($Z=48$) or Tellurium ($Z=52$) have 8 stable isotopes.

Similarly elements having neutron number equal to magic no. have ^{large} greater no. of isotones.

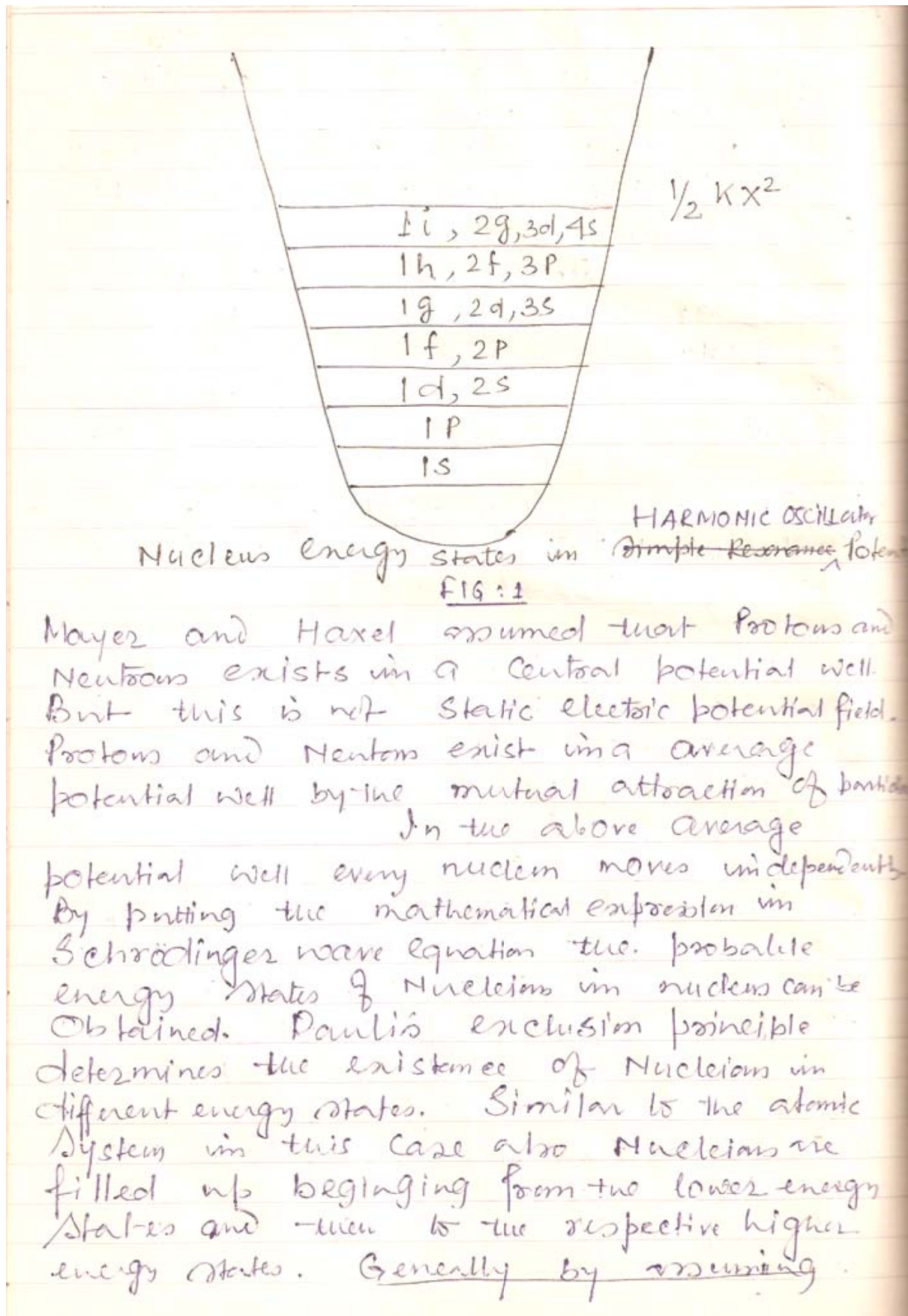
e.g for $N=82$ the no. of stable isotones = 7, but for $N=80$ or $N=84$ no. of stable isotones 3 & 2 respectively.

(c). The end product of three ^{Natural} radioactive series containing magic number of protons $Z=82$ is the isotope of Lead.

(d) The nucleus containing magic number of proton or neutron have much higher value for its 1st excited energy state in comparison to the neighbouring nucleus.

(e) The nucleus containing magic number of proton or neutron has smaller Neutron Capture cross-section. This is because that since the nucleus shell is completed therefore probability of proton or neutron capture is much less.

According to Quantum mechanics when a physical system such as atomic electron system or nucleus system is contained in a potential well then that physical system can exist in definite energy state.





infinite potential well or Harmonic Oscillator potential well the 3-dimensional Schrodinger wave eqⁿ is solved. Using this theory the existence of Nuclear energy shells can be explained. It is found few energy states exist very closely and then after a wide gap again energy states exist closely fig: 2. The closely situated energy states belong to a shell. Whenever a shell is completed with even number of nucleon then the energy needed to remove a nucleon is much higher. Thus the binding energy of completely filled shell is very large. The nucleon no. of such full shell is a magic number.

To get the above magic numbers we have to assume that the Spin-orbit Coupling force is much higher.

Due to L-S coupling the orbital angular momentum l splits into two sublevels. The total angular momentum quantum number for the two sublevels is respectively $J = l + \frac{1}{2}$ and $J = l - \frac{1}{2}$. Only when $l = 0$ then one value of $J = \frac{1}{2}$ is possible. Since l is an integer hence J is a fractional number.

Theoretically $J = l + \frac{1}{2}$ state possesses lower energy than $J = l - \frac{1}{2}$ state. The difference between the energy states increases with the increase in the value of l . For $l > 3$ the difference is so large that these two sublevels exist in two different energy shells. The total angular momentum of the nucleus (or Nuclear Spin)

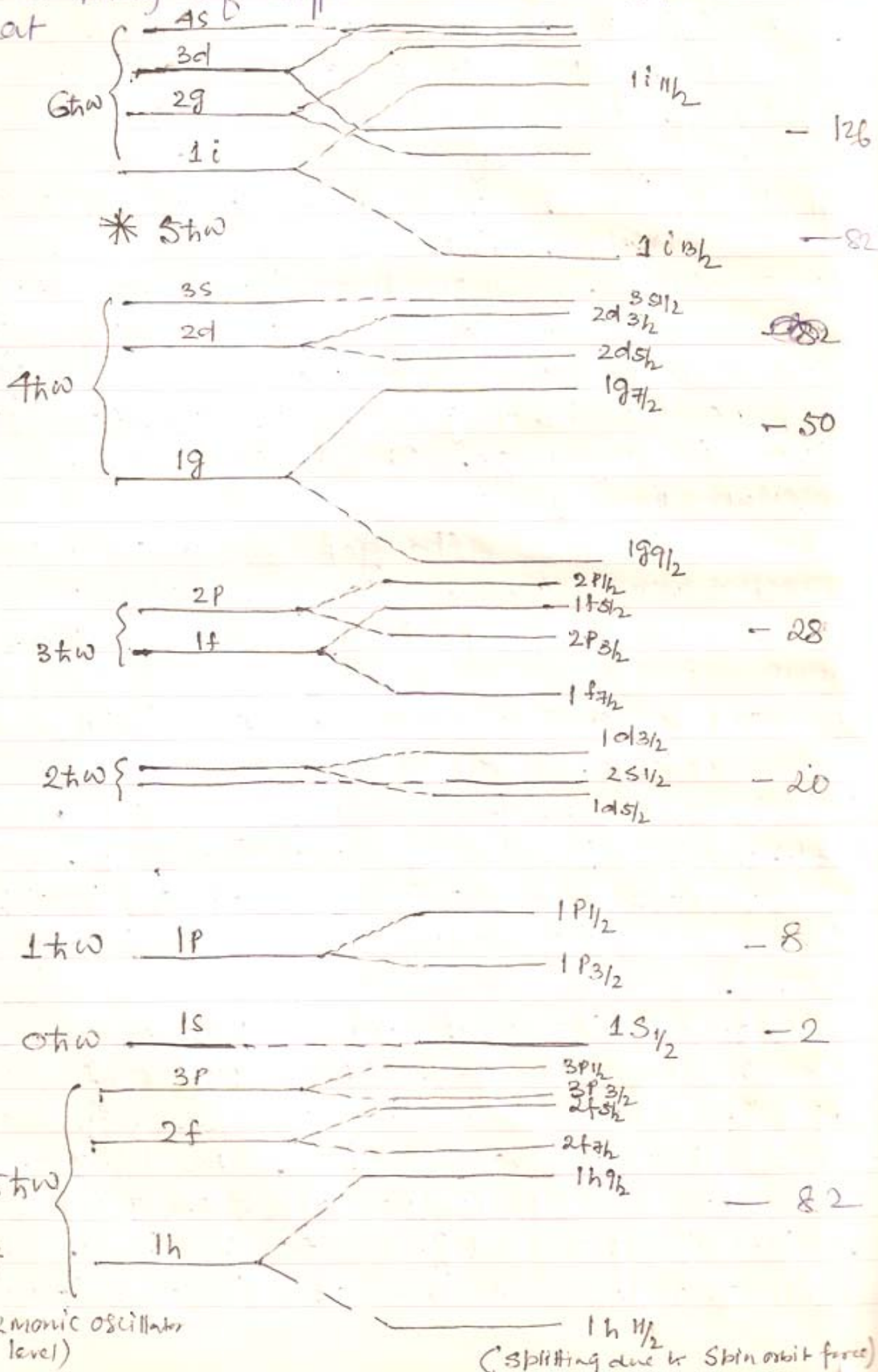


Shell Structure Of Nucleus



Shell Structure Of Nucleus

Quantum number I is determined by the J -coupling of different nucleons. It is evident that



Shell Structure Of Nucleus



FIG:2 Effect of spinorbit coupling on the level system of a well of a shape intermediate between the square and oscillator wells. The magic numbers are given on far right.

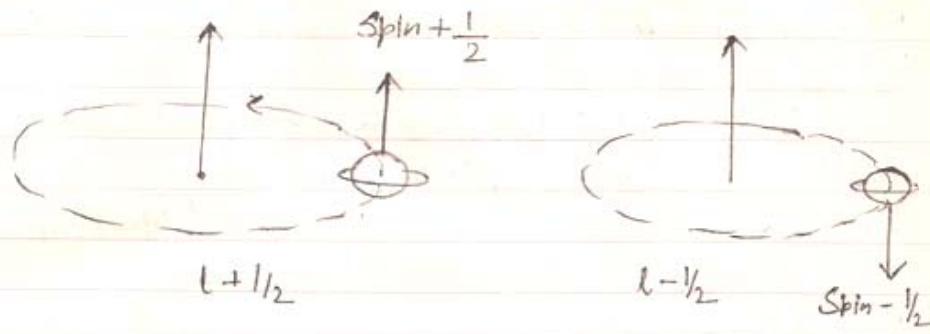


FIG:3

Coupling of orbital and spin angular momenta of a nucleus.

According to the Quantum no. n, l, J different nuclear energy states are represented.

$1s_{1/2}, 1p_{3/2}, 1p_{1/2}, 1d_{5/2}, 1d_{3/2}, 2s_{1/2}, \dots, 2f_{7/2}, \dots$

According to the Pauli's exclusion principle for energy sublevel J there can be $(2J+1)$ Number of Nucleons (Proton or Neutron). When the sublevel is filled by $(2J+1)$ Number of like nucleon then the excess like nucleon shifts to the higher energy state.

In the figure according to the Nuclear shell model the different probable Nuclear energy states ~~are~~ ^{have been} shown. The number of like nucleons that fill the shell is also shown.

From the fig:2 the importance of L-S coupling for the nuclear energy state splitting can be understood.

e.g. the energy of the sublevel $1f_{5/2}$ is ~~is~~ ^{higher} than $1f_{7/2}$ ($l=3$) ^{Hence} that as soon as the last sublevel is filled up the whole shell gets completely filled.



Consequently magic number 28 arises. Similarly the energy difference of $1g_{7/2}$ and $1g_{9/2}$ ($l=4$) is so high that they are situated in different shells from which magic number 50 arises.

Similarly magic number 82 and 126 arises due to L-S splitting of the sublevels $1h_{7/2}$ & $1h_{9/2}$ ($l=5$) and $1i_{13/2}$, $1i_{11/2}$ ($l=6$) respectively.

using nuclear shell model of nucleus not only magic number but also other properties such as Nuclear Spin, magnetic moment etc can be explained. To explain we assume:
For a definite J the like even nucleons (Proton or Neutron) are arranged in such a way that the total angular momentum or spin becomes zero. Hence for even numbered nucleons angular momentum is zero. On the other hand for the odd numbered Nucleon shell the angular momentum is equal to the angular momentum of the last unpaired electron. Thus we conclude:

When $Z = \text{Even}$, if $N = \text{even}$ then Nuclear Spin $I = 0$

when $Z = \text{even}$; $N = \text{Odd}$ then I is determined by the J of last odd numbered Neutron.

when $Z = \text{odd}$, $N = \text{even}$, then I is determined by the J of last odd numbered Proton.

Based on the above assumptions the nuclear shell model is termed as single particle model. using this model the Nucleus possessing even-even if odd A ; the Nuclear Spin can be determined.

Shell Structure Of Nucleus



We know that for Even-Even & Odd-A the Nuclear Spin is zero ($I=0$).

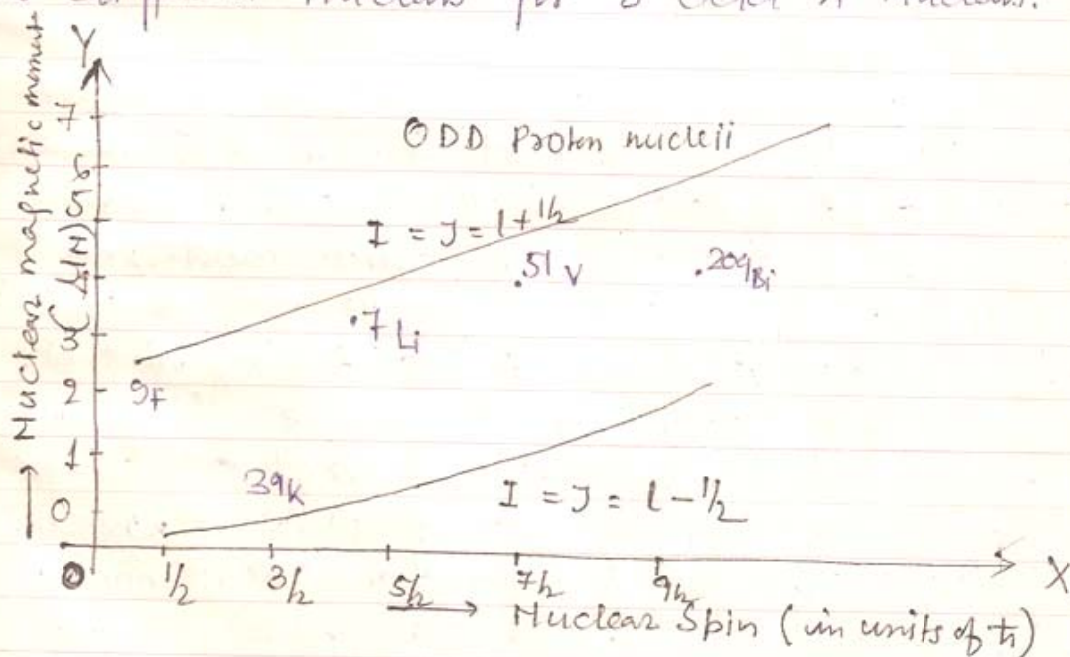
Let us consider the Nuclei having odd A.

For the Nucleus

${}^3\text{H}$ ($Z=1$) & ${}^3\text{He}$ ($N=1$) we get $I = \frac{1}{2}$

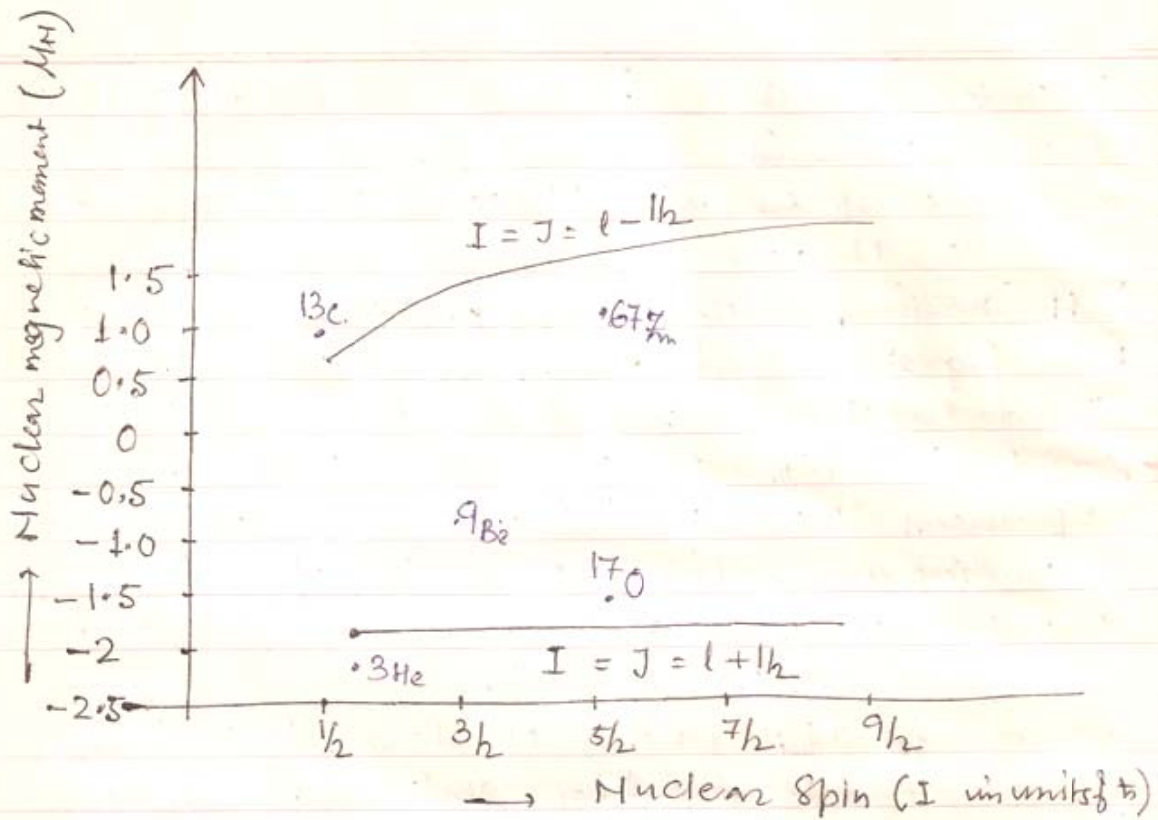
From fig ② we find for both cases the odd nucleons (respectively 1 proton & 1 Neutron) exist in $1s_{\frac{1}{2}}$ energy state. Since for each of them having like even nucleons (respectively 2 Neutrons and 2 protons) $I=0$ therefore for both the Nuclei spin is equal to the last odd Nucleon $J = \frac{1}{2}$. $I = \frac{1}{2}$.

Again for ${}^7\text{Li}$ ($Z=3$) Nucleus the 3rd proton exist in $1p_{\frac{3}{2}}$ state because the lowest state $1s_{\frac{1}{2}}$ is filled up by $2J+1=2$ protons. Hence in this case $I = \frac{3}{2}$ which agrees with experimental result. Actually this model successfully explain the I for different Nucleus for 3 odd A Nucleus.



Schmidt lines (for odd Proton nucleus).

FIG: 4.



Schmidt lines for Nucleus having odd A

using Shell model — the value of magnetic moment for different nucleus having odd A can be found.

The observed nuclear magnetic moments can also be understood in terms of J value of the odd nucleon in the nucleus. On the basis of the independent particle model, we expect the spins and magnetic moments of isotopic nuclei of odd A , differing in their A values by two, not to change, since the two added Nucleons are paired off and do not affect the single odd Nucleon which is responsible for the spin and magnetic moment of the isotopic nuclei. This is found to be the case with odd A isotopes.



Magnetic moment of single odd nucleon = $(g_l l^* + g_s s^*) \mu_N$

where g_l and g_s are respectively orbital and spin g factors of the single odd nucleon.

$$\vec{j}^* = \vec{l}^* + \vec{s}^*, \quad I = j$$

The value μ of the nuclear magnetic moment experimentally obtained in the case where $I = j$ is

$$\begin{aligned} \mu &= (\text{the nucleon magnetic moment along } \vec{j}^*) \frac{j}{j^*} \\ &= [g_l l^* \cos(\vec{l}^* \vec{j}^*) + g_s s^* \cos(\vec{s}^* \vec{j}^*)] \frac{j}{j^*} \mu_N \quad \text{--- (2)} \end{aligned}$$

The cosines are evaluated from:

$$\left. \begin{aligned} s^{*2} &= j^{*2} + l^{*2} - 2 j^* l^* \cos(\vec{l}^* \vec{j}^*) \\ l^{*2} &= j^{*2} + s^{*2} - 2 j^* s^* \cos(\vec{s}^* \vec{j}^*) \end{aligned} \right\}$$

$$\therefore \text{from (2): } \mu = \left(g_l \frac{j^{*2} + l^{*2} - s^{*2}}{2 j^*} + g_s \frac{j^{*2} + s^{*2} - l^{*2}}{2 j^*} \right) \frac{j}{j^*} \mu_N$$

Taking $S = 1/2$ for a single nucleon we get

$$\text{For } j = l + 1/2 \quad ; \quad l = j - 1/2, \quad \mu = [(j - 1/2) g_l + \frac{1}{2} g_s] \mu_N \quad \text{--- (3)}$$

$$\text{For } j = l - 1/2 \quad ; \quad l = j + 1/2; \quad \mu = \frac{j}{j+1} [(j + 3/2) g_l - \frac{1}{2} g_s] \mu_N$$

The μ versus j curves gives Schmidt lines. It is found that (μ, j) points do not fall on the Schmidt lines rather confined to the region between the Schmidt lines.

The observed anomalous magnetic moments of nucleon may be attributed



Shell Structure Of Nucleus

to their basic structure of a nucleonic core surrounded by the presence of the other nucleons in a nucleus, the magnetic moment of a nucleon in a nucleus may not be same as that of the free nucleon. This may probably explain the failure of the shell model to predict quantitatively the magnetic.